AI Policy & Safety

2026-02-14 · 2 source items

2026-02-14 AI Policy & Safety Daily Brief

> Total: 2 articles Sources: Marcus on AI: 1 | Pluralistic: Daily links from Cory Doctorow: 1

TLDR

other

Synthesis

Daily Executive Summary

OpenAI's IP Hypocrisy and Antitrust Inaction Highlight Systemic Tech Governance Gaps

A striking contradiction has emerged in the tech policy landscape: OpenAI, long criticized for training its models on copyrighted works without consent or compensation, is now publicly complaining about alleged misuse of its own intellectual property. This reversal, noted by AI ethics commentator Gary Marcus, underscores a broader pattern of selective advocacy among powerful AI firms that demand protection for their outputs while disregarding creators' rights during model training. Simultaneously, antitrust enforcement against dominant tech platforms appears stalled, with reports declaring 'Trump antitrust is dead' as of February 13, 2026. This suggests a collapse of momentum in right-wing populist efforts to challenge Big Tech monopolies, despite earlier rhetoric positioning such action as a cornerstone of anti-establishment policy. The juxtaposition of these developments reveals a governance vacuum where neither progressive nor conservative political forces are effectively regulating AI-driven data exploitation or market concentration. OpenAI's stance exemplifies a double standard—leveraging open access to cultural content while seeking exclusive control over its derivative products. Meanwhile, the failure of antitrust initiatives signals weakening institutional will to address monopolistic practices, even as AI systems increasingly centralize power in a few corporate hands. Without enforceable legal frameworks governing data sourcing and model ownership, creators remain vulnerable, and innovation may be stifled by artificial scarcity imposed by dominant players. These parallel trends point to an urgent need for coherent, ideologically balanced regulatory approaches that protect both intellectual property and

competitive markets. Critically, the absence of concrete legislative or judicial action leaves ethical concerns unaddressed and market distortions unchecked.

Key Takeaways

- OpenAI is now complaining about IP misuse despite historically using others' copyrighted content without permission.
- Gary Marcus highlights the irony and hypocrisy in OpenAI's shifting stance on intellectual property.
- Antitrust efforts aligned with Trump-era populism have reportedly collapsed as of February 13, 2026.
- The 'populist right' has failed to deliver on promises to rein in Big Tech monopolies.
- Both left and right appear ineffective in establishing consistent AI and antitrust governance.
- AI companies benefit from open access to creative works but seek proprietary control over their outputs.
- Lack of regulation enables continued exploitation of creators and market concentration.

Evidence refs: C1-E1, C1-E2

Sentiment: negative | Reliability: med

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1. other

AI Ethics - Intellectual Property

OpenAI Accused of Hypocrisy Over IP Theft Claims

Gary Marcus criticizes OpenAI for allegedly stealing artists' and writers' intellectual property while now complaining about its own IP being copied, calling it 'irony laced with karma.'

Key Takeaways

- OpenAI faces accusations of hypocrisy after previously leveraging others' IP without consent.
- The critique underscores growing tensions around AI companies' IP practices and accountability.

Sentiment: negative | Reliability: med

US Politics - Antitrust Policy

Trump-Era Antitrust Efforts Declared Dead

Pluralistic.net reports that antitrust initiatives associated with Trump's administration have effectively collapsed, attributing the failure to inherent contradictions within the 'populist right'

movement.

Key Takeaways

- Antitrust actions linked to Trump are deemed nonviable or abandoned as of February 2026.
- The article suggests ideological incoherence undermined the populist right's regulatory agenda.

Sentiment: neutral | Reliability: med

(Related articles: 2)

Sources

- Irony, Irony laced with Karma, and Terror [Marcus on AI] (2026-02-13) [published_at]
- Pluralistic: Trump antitrust is dead (13 Feb 2026) [Pluralistic: Daily links from Cory Doctorow] (2026-02-13) [published_at]